# PS5 Dump & Image Converter
# Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Short answers to the questions that come up most often when working with the program – from the first start through converting to the PS5. The user manual covers everything in detail.

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## 1 General

### Q What does the PS5 Dump & Image Converter do?

It converts backups of PS5 games between the common formats, unpacks them, packs them and checks them – through an interface with eight clearly separated tasks. On top of that come tools for working with a PS5 that is already jailbroken: finding the console, starting payloads, library, save data, AMPR EMU, BACKPORT and more.

> The program is meant only for content you **own and acquired legally**.

### Q Which formats does the program know?

| Format | What it is |
|---|---|
| Dump folder | A normal folder with the game's files (`eboot.bin`, `sce_sys` …). |
| `.ffpfsc` | Compact, compressed container – one single file. |
| `.ffpfs` | Like `.ffpfsc`, but uncompressed: larger, but faster to build. |
| `.exFAT` | A real file system image in exFAT format. |
| `.ffpkg` | Container with a UFS2 file system; checked automatically after writing. Windows only. |

The program can read packages (`.pkg`, `.fpkg`) and show them in the library; PS4 packages are converted with dedicated tools (see section 4).

### Q Which target format should I choose?

For a USB drive and for passing a game on, **`.ffpfsc`** is usually the best choice – it is compressed. `.ffpfs` builds faster but is larger. You only need `.exFAT` and `.ffpkg` when another workflow expects exactly that format.

On a USB drive the console does not read a loose folder but a container that ShadowMount+ mounts. That is exactly why task 1 turns a dump folder into one single file.

### Q Which task fits my source?

| What do you have? | Task | What for |
|---|---|---|
| A dump folder | 1 | Convert to `.ffpfsc`, `.ffpfs`, `.exFAT` or `.ffpkg`. |
| An `.ffpfsc` | 2 | Unpack into a folder or convert to another format. |
| An `.exFAT` | 3 | Unpack or convert to `.ffpfsc` / `.ffpfs` / `.ffpkg`. |
| An `.ffpkg` | 4 | Unpack, convert or build again as a verified `.ffpkg`. |
| Several containers | 5 | All of them, one after another, into the same target format. |
| You are not sure what it is | 6 | The source is detected automatically and exported. |
| Set up or switch AMPR EMU | 7 | Apply a version, back up the original, build the index – also directly on the PS5. |
| Only check | 8 | Check integrity without changing anything. |

### Q Can I use a .zip, .7z or .rar directly as the source?

Yes. In task 1 the **Archive…** button picks an archive (or drag it onto the source field), in task 5 (batch conversion) archives can be added like any other source, and on the command line `--source Game.zip` works. The program unpacks the archive into the work folder, takes the game folder inside it (the one with `sce_sys/param.json`) as the source and removes the unpacked folder afterwards. At least as much free space as the archive's size is needed there. If the archive is password-protected and none of the common passwords fits, the program asks you.

### Q My game is a plain ELF file and does not start on the PS5. What can I do?

A game whose `eboot.bin` and modules are plain ELF files never starts on the PS5, because the loader rejects them. When a task starts and the program finds such **unsigned programs** in a folder, it asks whether to write them as fake-signed SELF files when creating. Under **SETTINGS** in the section *Unsigned programs* this can be switched on permanently without asking. Already signed programs stay untouched.

### Q Which systems does the program run on?

On **Windows** (ready-made EXE), **Linux** and **macOS**. On Linux and macOS two paths are missing that only work with Windows tools:

- reading and creating `.ffpkg` – that is, task 4 and `.ffpkg` as target format (UFS2Tool and the Dokan driver exist only for Windows),
- the fallback paths via OSFMount (these only kick in for unusual images anyway).

Everything else – dump folder, `.ffpfsc`, `.ffpfs` and `.exFAT` in every direction, batch conversion, AMPR EMU Manager and Validator – is fully available there.

### Q What does the program cost, and which license applies?

The program is free and, since 7 October 2026, released under the **GNU General Public License, version 3 or later** (GPL-3.0-or-later, file `LICENSE`); versions up to and including v1.9.64 were published under the MIT license. The bundled third-party components keep their own licenses: they are listed in `THIRD_PARTY_LICENSES.md` and can be reached via **CREDITS**. Almost everything the program does builds on the work of others – for example MkPFS (PFS processing), UFS2Tool, LibProsperoPkg, PS4 FFPFSC and dozens of payloads from the homebrew community.

## 2 Installation and start

### Q Why does Windows ask for administrator rights at startup?

The Windows version always requires administrator rights – among other things for the `.ffpkg` paths (UFS2) and for mounting with OSFMount. If you decline the prompt, the program does not start. On Linux and macOS it starts as a normal user.

### Q My antivirus flags or removes the EXE. What can I do?

Programs built with PyInstaller are occasionally flagged by mistake. The program does not add any exceptions to your antivirus and does not install certificates. Only get the EXE from the project's own source; if the source is right, you can add the file as an exception in your antivirus yourself.

### Q The Linux file does not start. Why?

1. Make the file executable once (`X.Y.Z` stands for your version):

   ```
   chmod +x PS5_Dump_Image_Converter_vX.Y.Z_linux_x86_64
   ```

2. The ready-made Linux file needs a **current system** (system library glibc 2.42 or newer, for example Ubuntu 26.04). It does not start on older systems such as Ubuntu 24.04, Linux Mint 22 or Debian 13.
3. In that case build the program on your own computer – in the project folder with `./Build_Linux.sh`, **without** `sudo`. If Tcl/Tk is missing, the script names the matching install command.

### Q On the Mac, “the developer cannot be verified” appears.

macOS marks everything that arrives via browser, mail or AirDrop. The install script (`Install_macOS.sh` or `Erste Installation.command` from the disk image) removes the mark itself. By hand it works like this:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine "/Applications/PS5 Dump & Image Converter.app
```

Note: a Mac version only fits Macs of the same type – a version for Apple Silicon does not run on an Intel Mac and vice versa.

### Q Do I need OSFMount, Dokan or other additional programs?

Normally not. The program reads `.exFAT` images with its built-in reader – without mounting, without administrator rights, on every system. OSFMount is only the fallback on Windows for unusually built images; the program then says so and can install OSFMount itself. FileZilla is optional and only needed for the **FILEZILLA** button.

### Q Where does the program store its settings?

| System | Folder |
|---|---|
| Windows | `%APPDATA%\PS5ImageConverterPro` |
| Linux | `~/.config/PS5ImageConverterPro/` |
| macOS | `~/Library/Application Support/PS5ImageConverterPro/` |

The diagnostic reports are stored there too. If the settings file is damaged, the program starts with default values – it then looks as if it had forgotten everything. The environment check (“doctor”, section 6) detects that.

## 3 Converting and formats

### Q How do I convert safely?

1. Choose the matching task on the left.
2. Choose the source with the button next to SOURCE.
3. If shown, choose the TARGET FORMAT – and, if needed, compression and workers.
4. Choose a **separate** TARGET FOLDER and a writable TEMP FOLDER.
5. Check all paths and press START.
6. Keep the program open until the log reports successful completion.

> **Rule of thumb:** keep a copy → matching task → separate target folder → enough space → wait for the success message. Delete the originals only once the result is finished and, if needed, checked with task 8.

### Q How much free space do I need?

The program calculates this before starting and tells you if it is not enough. As a guide, relative to the size of the source:

| Target format | Space needed, roughly |
|---|---|
| `.ffpfsc` | 0.75 times |
| `.ffpfs`, `.exFAT` | 1.1 times |
| `.ffpkg` | 1.3 times |

If **AMPR EMU** or **BACKPORT** is ticked, a complete working copy of the game is also created in the work folder. If the work and target folders are on the same drive, the sum counts.

### Q A run stopped with “The source folder was emptied during the build”. What happened?

The working copy in the temp folder lost its files during the build – not through the program. A common cause is **Windows Storage Sense**: when space runs low it deletes files in the Windows temp folder. Choose your own folder on a large drive under **TEMP FOLDER** below (e.g. `D:\PS5-Temp`) and repeat the run. The program warns at the start of a run when the temp folder is at risk; batch conversion removes working copies after each game. With **Dump folder: create a working copy first** the question before an integration is also skipped.

### Q Which compression level is right?

1 is the fastest, 9 gives the smallest file; for a start, “6 – Balanced” is enough. Don't expect miracles: PS5 game data is largely compressed already. Measured on a 664 MB dump, levels 1 and 9 differed by only about 5 % in size – higher levels mainly cost time.

### Q What do WORKERS and VERIFY mean?

**WORKERS** sets how many operations run at the same time. One processor core always stays free, and very large images are throttled further. You set it with the rotary knob – turn it with the mouse, use the mouse wheel or the arrow keys; a double-click resets it.

**VERIFY** decides whether the finished image is checked after packing: “Quick” checks the structure, “Full” also reads everything back and takes considerably longer.

### Q Can I change a finished image afterwards?

Not directly – a finished image has no free space for additional files. There are three ways, though:

- **EDIT IMAGE** (under **MORE TOOLS**): the program unpacks the image, you replace, rename, delete or add files, and it saves the result as a new image `<name>_bearbeitet` in the format you choose ( `.ffpfsc` , `.ffpfs` , `.ffpkg` or `.exFAT` ). The original stays untouched; `eboot.bin` and `sce_sys/param.json` can only be replaced, not deleted or renamed.
- **Build the same format again, with integration** (tasks 2 to 6): the same file as source, the same format as target, tick what should go in (asset pack, PlayGo, BACKPORT) and start. The program unpacks, integrates and rebuilds; you need the game's size once as free space in the work folder.
- Unpack into a **dump folder**, edit the folder yourself and pack it again.

### Q What is “Dump folder (with integration)”?

If AMPR EMU, PlayGo or BACKPORT is ticked in task 1, this target format appears in addition. Then no image is created, but a dump folder with exactly these integrations. At the start the program asks where to integrate:

- **Into a backup (recommended)** – the dump is copied into the target folder and only the copy is changed.
- **Into the original** – directly in your folder. The files are no longer original afterwards; BACKPORT replaces `eboot.bin` and libraries without a backup. This cannot be undone.

### Q Can the computer shut down on its own after a long conversion?

Yes – with the checkbox **Shut down the computer after a successful run** under TEMP FOLDER. Only after a *successful* run does a window appear that counts down 60 seconds (cancel with the button or ESC). Then images are unmounted, working files removed and the log saved, and the computer shuts down without further questions. After an error or a cancellation it stays on. Save your work in other programs beforehand.

### Q Does it also work without the interface, from the command line?

Yes, every task also runs without a window – using the same workflow logic as the interface (`X.Y.Z` stands for your version):

```
PS5_Dump_Image_Converter_vX.Y.Z.exe --cli --task 1 --source "D:\Dumps\Game"
```

`--format` knows `folder`, `ffpfsc`, `ffpfs`, `exfat` and `ffpkg`; `--yes` confirms prompts, `--shutdown-on-success` shuts down afterwards. On Windows, open the command prompt or PowerShell **as administrator** – otherwise the call stops with return code 3.

### Q How do I convert several files or dump folders at once?

With **task 5 – Batch conversion**: click **Choose sources** and decide whether they are dump folders or image files (`.ffpfsc`, `.exFAT` or `.ffpkg`). For dump folders the Windows folder dialog opens: mark several folders with Ctrl or Shift, then click **Select Folder**. A folder that is not a dump itself (such as *Game Dumps*) stands for all the dumps and images inside it. Then set one common target format and start. Every source is processed and checked on its own; if one fails, the others still run to the end. Test a single source first and check that there is space for all results.

### Q How do I check a backup without changing anything?

With **task 8 – Validator**. It reports missing required files, a damaged file system or wrong nesting. For `.ffpfsc` and `.ffpfs` it looks one level deeper without unpacking: `nesting: fine` is the result you want, `wrongly nested` means the file has to be created again.

> **Not checked is not a verdict:** an `.ffpkg` can only be checked with administrator rights. Without them the result is NOT CHECKED – not “failed”. On the command line, task 8 then returns 4 (0 = fine, 1 = problems found).

### Q A run was cancelled or failed. What now?

After CANCEL, wait for the confirmation in the log. Do not keep using an incomplete result – delete it and start again with checked paths. If a warning appears, read the full message and fix the stated cause first instead of changing several things at once. Keep the log and the source until the cause is clear.

## 4 On the PS5

### Q What has to be prepared on the console?

- A PS5 that has already been prepared with a jailbreak method of its own – the program does not perform this step.
- **ShadowMount+**, which mounts the images.
- For transfers, an FTP payload: **ftpsrv on port 2121**. The program starts it on request via the ELF loader (port 9021).

### Q Where does the image go on the USB drive?

**Directly into the root of the drive** – or into the folders `homebrew` or `etaHEN/games` on it. ShadowMount+ only searches fixed places (USB drives `usb0` to `usb7`, plus `/data/homebrew`, `/data/etaHEN/games` and the M.2 expansion). An image in a subfolder of your own is not found.

> An entry in ShadowMount+'s `manual.lst` does make a folder of your own reachable, but it does not reliably survive a restart: with several USB devices attached, the drive number can change.

### Q Which FTP payload should I use?

Bundled and preset is **ftpsrv-ps5 on port 2121**; the program has been tested with it. After every upload the program checks whether the files are executable and warns in the log otherwise.

### Q The game does not start. What do the error codes mean?

| Code | Cause and remedy |
|---|---|
| `CE-108255-1` | An incomplete `.ffpkg` – or starting from internal storage instead of the USB stick. Try the backup from the stick. |
| `CE-107891-6` | An update package does not match the installed base package (even a rebuild of the same game counts as a different package). Install the matching base package or rebuild both together. Which updates exist for a game is shown by **PS4 PKG Dump & Image Converter** in the *Parts* column. |
| `CE-100096-6` | The console rejects a self-built package. For game backups the way via image and ShadowMount+ is the right one; for your own homebrew use **Install app directly**. |

### Q What is AMPR EMU, and when do I need it?

When a game starts, the PS5 asks its APR file resolver where the game files are. If the game runs from a mounted image, the resolver gets no usable answer – and the game does not start. AMPR EMU is a replacement library that answers this question on its behalf. You need it for games that are meant to run from an image.

You can integrate it while creating (checkbox **AMPR EMU** in tasks 1 to 6) or via **button 7**: it opens a selection with the *new method* (ShadowMount+ from 1.7 alpha8), the *old method* (up to alpha6) and *Build AMPR EMU into the backup*. The program checks itself which ShadowMount+ version runs on the console and, if necessary, advises you to use the other button.

If AMPR EMU has no effect, check the ShadowMount+ `config.ini`: if the game's title ID is listed under `fakelib_exclude` (from version 1.7beta4) or is switched off with `fakelib_mode=<ID>:disabled` or via `fakelib_default_mode=disabled` (from 1.7beta5), ShadowMount+ mounts no `fakelib` at all for this title. The AMPR EMU Manager (button 9 of the CONSOLE view) and the AMPR trace assistant ask in this case and name the entry before placing anything; change it under **MORE TOOLS → SHADOWMOUNT+**.

### What are asset packs?

With the method **Asset pack**, the game files are additionally put into packed bands (`ampr_assets-*.pak`) that AMPR EMU reads block by block from version 0.4.2.1 on. This saves space and file descriptors on the console. For this, **both** drop-down lists must be right: AMPR version `test-pack` (or `test-debug-pack` for troubleshooting) and method *Asset pack* – the version `test-nopack` that is preselected at the top cannot do it.

Every packed block is checked byte by byte against the original file. Your original files stay in place unless you choose otherwise; only leave them out after a successful test on the console. The detailed guide opens with the **LZ4 & Asset Pack Guide** button.

For *ASTRO BOT*, *EA Sports UFC 6* and games built on the *Unity* or *Insomniac* engine, the program automatically sets up a tested pack profile (since v1.9.78). A profile of your own next to the dump folder (`<folder name>_ampr_pack.toml`) always takes precedence.

### Q How strongly is it packed, and how do I check or unpack a finished asset pack?

**The strength** is set under **SETTINGS** in the section *ASSET PACK (LZ4)* (since v1.9.80). The default is level **9**: measured on real game data, level 12 saves only 0.0 to 0.6 percentage points more but takes 1.2 to 3.6 times as long. Images, textures, archives, audio, video and configuration files stay loose in the general profile because they are already compressed.

**LZ4 or zstd:** Under **SETTINGS**, in the same section, choose the *pack method*. LZ4 (the default) builds `ampr_assets-*.pak`. zstd builds `ampr_zstd.index` and `ampr_zstd-NNN.pak`, packs every file except the system files and usually compresses more, but is read *only* by ampr-emu-ng (NG), not by the drakmor runtime. With zstd the version list offers NG only; the zstd level runs from 1 to 22 (default 5). Custom rules (which files stay loose) are read from a file `<folder name>_ampr_pack.toml` next to the dump folder or, once for all games, from the file you choose in the settings under “Pack rules for zstd”; system files always stay loose. Whether a game with zstd packs starts on the console has not been measured; the packed originals are missing from the result, so keep the source dump (it stays unchanged).

**Checking and unpacking** is under **MORE TOOLS → ASSET PACK CHECK / UNPACK** (since v1.9.80). Choose the game folder that holds `ampr_assets.index`: *CHECK* reads every block against the checksums and tells you whether the library in the folder can read volumes; *UNPACK* puts the packed files back as loose files – into a new folder (the game folder stays) or into the game folder itself (the volumes are deleted afterwards). An image cannot be opened this way; unpack it with task 2 first.

### Q How do I download an official PS5 update from Sony?

Choose the game as the source and open **Game Info**. If the game's `sce_sys\param.json` names Sony's update list ( `versionFileUri` ), rows labelled **PS5 · Sony (official)** appear with version, size and required firmware (since v1.9.81). Clicking **Download** fetches the package straight to this computer: in parts, resumable, every part checked against Sony's SHA-256. It lands in *PS5 Spiele Updates* (newest version) or *Patches*. Nothing is installed, and the file is not sent to the console.

If nanoDNS runs on your PS5, `sgst.prod.dl.playstation.net` and `gs2.ww.prod.dl.playstation.net` belong in its `[exceptions]` – by default only `gst.prod.dl.playstation.net` is listed.

### Q What does the “PlayGo” checkbox do?

It places a replacement for `libScePlayGo.sprx` in the game that reports all language and scenario packages as installed. Most games do not need this, so it is off by default. If a title declares PlayGo content and the checkbox is not set, the program asks at the beginning of the run – before anything is copied, unpacked or packed.

### Q What does the “DLC EMU” checkbox do?

It places three replacement libraries ( `libSceAppContent` , `libSceNpEntitlementAccess` and `libSceGameUpdate` ) in the game so that the console reports add-on content as present. Which content counts is listed in `dlc_emu.ini` in the game folder; if it is missing, the program creates it from the game’s `dlcmap.json` . Add-on content that only unlocks something is entered as a plain entitlement. The checkbox is off by default. If the game has add-on content ( `dlcmap.json` , a DLC folder next to the game or a `dlc_emu.ini` ) and the checkbox is not set, the program asks at the beginning of the run. Without a matching `dlc_emu.ini` , DLC EMU reports no add-on content.

### Q Can I create the backport as a separate folder for ShadowMount+?

Yes. In the BACKPORT window, **Create backport folder only …** creates the folder `backports/<title ID>` – with the lowered files, the `param.json` and the `fakelib` folder. The game itself stays untouched. Put the folder on the console at `/data/homebrew/backports/<title ID>/` ; ShadowMount+ lays it over the game at launch. The program can also send it there via FTP right away. The target firmware is preselected to match the console.

### Q What does BACKPORT do?

A PS5 game records which development kit (SDK) it was built with; the console starts nothing that is newer than its firmware. **BACKPORT** (under MORE TOOLS) lowers this value to a target firmware – **4.00, 5.00, 6.00 or 7.00** – and places matching replacement libraries in a `fakelib` folder. Beforehand the list shows every file and what would happen to it; a backup of the folder is preset.

> The result only runs on a jailbroken console. Whether a game starts after the backport cannot be told in advance – keep the backup until it runs on the console. The **coverage check** (always on) shows whether functions the game requires are missing from the replacement libraries.

### Q My game does not start after the backport – is there anything else to tick?

The BACKPORT window has two additional checkboxes. Both are **off by default** and both come **without any guarantee**, because they change game code:

- **Neutralize missing functions (stubs, experimental)** – If the game requires a function that the target firmware does not know and that no replacement library can provide, it aborts at the first call. This checkbox replaces that call inside the game with an empty return value. Whether the game then runs correctly is open.
- **Apply the game's correction profile (if available)** – For individual titles, verified byte corrections are included, each for exactly one version of the game (included: Anno 117 on firmware 4.xx). A profile is only applied if the checksum of the unmodified original file matches; otherwise everything stays as it is.

The checkboxes also apply to the integration while creating. The log names every changed spot – keep the backup.

### How do I turn an ELF into an eboot.bin?

**ELF → EBOOT.BIN** (under MORE TOOLS) wraps an `.elf` – for example a homebrew you built yourself – as `eboot.bin`: a SELF wrapper with the ELF inside. Afterwards the program reads the file back as a check. A file that is already a SELF, a stripped ELF and anything that is not an ELF are refused with a note.

> The `eboot.bin` is a fake SELF without a real signature and only starts on a jailbroken console.

### Does a tile I create appear under Games or under Media?

That is not decided by the `eboot.bin` but by `sce_sys/param.json`: its field `applicationCategoryType` puts the tile under **Games** with **0** and under **Media** with **65536**. The console reads it when the app is installed or registered; afterwards it can only be changed by installing again. In **Install app directly** (MORE TOOLS) you choose it under *Tile under*; Media is preset.

### Can I use PS4 games too?

Yes. **PS4 PKG Dump & Image Converter** (task 7 – PKG / FPKG, page PKG) reads your PS4 packages and turns base, update and optionally DLC into a normal game folder (format **Dump folder**), an image for ShadowMount+ (**ffpfsc** or **exFAT**) or a merged package. **ONLINE UPDATES** downloads missing updates for PS4 games from Sony. PS5 packages (debug packages, FPKG) are unpacked and converted by **PS5 PKG Dump & Image Converter** (task 7 – PKG / FPKG, page FPKG).

> **Trophies:** a PS4 game that starts from an image does not register its trophies (*Trophy registration failed, 0x80551618*). This is by design and not caused by the image. If you need the trophies, install the game with the Package Installer. PS5 titles are not affected.

### Q Can I send a package to the console over the network?

Yes, with **PS4 PKG Dump & Image Converter** (task 7 – PKG / FPKG, page PKG): read in the packages, choose a game, press **SEND TO CONSOLE** and enter the console's address. There are two ways: on a PS5 the OnionHEN package manager (called *DPI v2* in *Console & payloads*) receives the package and installs it; a PS4 fetches it from the PC through the Remote Package Installer. **Detect** asks which service answers at the address.

> **Untested:** sending has not yet been tried on a console – both ways are tested against stand-ins for the services. Whether a particular package starts afterwards can only be told by trying.

### Q Can I unpack a PS5 package without needing space on the PC?

Yes. In **PS5 PKG Dump & Image Converter** (task 7 – PKG / FPKG, page FPKG) choose the action **Unpack to the PS5**, enter the console's address and the folder there (for example `/mnt/usb0/GameName`) and start. The program reads the package and sends the files straight to the PS5 over FTP; no unpacked copy is made on the PC. `ftpsrv` must be running on the console. If the folder already exists there, you can **resume** (complete files are skipped, unfinished ones continue) or rewrite everything; if the connection drops, the program reconnects up to five times and carries on from where it stopped. Cancelling takes effect after the current file.

> **Untested:** Unpacking to the console is checked against a real package and a stand-in FTP server (every file byte for byte the same), but has not yet been tried on a PS5. Try it with a small game first.

### Q Can I build a PKG myself from a game folder, and what does the "builder" do?

Yes, in **PS5 PKG Dump & Image Converter** (task 7 – PKG / FPKG, page FPKG): choose the game folder, the target folder, the **Package** tile, then *Start conversion*. In **Options**, the **builder** sets which tool builds it – **LibProsperoPkg** (default, with compression, firmware and backport options in the *Build* tab) or **ProsperoPkgTool** (second package builder, MIT license). The *Build* tab also lets you embed **BACKPORT** right before the build, set a **minimum firmware**, or check **patch mode** for an update PKG.

### Q What do "Game Details" and "Show files" do?

**Game Details** (with a game folder selected) opens a window with the game's signed SELF/ELF files, the entries from `sce_sys/activity.json`, and the trophy sets found. **Show files** (with a package selected) shows the inner layout of the `.pkg` as an expandable tree and lets you extract single files or whole subtrees without unpacking the whole package.

### Q What do Fast, Balanced, Maximum and Low RAM do?

The four buttons under **PRESET** (in the CONVERT view, next to the checkboxes at the bottom of the card) set the compression level and the core count in one go: *Fast* level 3 with all cores, *Balanced* level 6 and *Maximum* level 9 with half the cores, *Low RAM* level 3 with one core. The block size stays at 65536. Measured on a 664 MB dump, levels 1 and 9 differ by only about 5 % in image size (PS5 game data hardly compresses); more cores shorten the time but need more memory. How much memory is free during a run is shown by the live display below the log.

### Q A game hangs on the loading screen.

Some titles stay at a “Please wait” when started from the image, while the same package runs when installed with the Package Installer. Ruled out so far: the storage location, missing PlayGo content, an online check and an incomplete image – **the cause is still open**. By no means every title is affected.

## 5 Console, library and payloads

### Q What does the CONSOLE view show?

Below the logo, **CONSOLE ›** switches to a second view with ten tools: *Console & payloads*, *WebKit Autoloader*, *Library*, *Prospero Manager*, *CoolSysCent-Pro*, *ShadowMount+*, *SMPlusGui*, *BFpilot*, *AMPR EMU Manager* and *AMPR trace*. **‹ CONVERT** leads back; the source, settings and a running job are kept.

**Console & payloads** already finds the PS5 by itself when the program starts – you do not have to enter an address. The page queries all known ports, shows state, version and purpose for every service, starts missing services from the bundled `helloworld` folder and opens web interfaces. On Windows these appear directly in the program, otherwise in the browser.

**Prospero Manager**, **CoolSysCent-Pro** (the PS5 Cooling & System Center, port 8086), **ShadowMount+**, **SMPlusGui** and **BFpilot** (a second file manager, port 5905) have no page of their own: one press checks whether the payload is already running on the console, sends it by itself if needed – together with the ELF loader if port 9021 is still closed – and then opens its web interface.

### Q How do I have payloads sent to the PS5 automatically (favorites)?

On *Console & payloads* the first column of the table carries a star. A click on ☆ (or the space bar on the selected row) makes the service a **favorite**, another click takes it out again. The line above the table names the current favorites.

- The program sends favorites by itself **when it starts** and on demand with **Send favorites**. By default these are the FTP server and the kernel log; **Default** restores that.
- Only what is not running gets sent, in the order of the table. A service that "hangs" (see below) is not sent again.
- **Port 9021** is part of every send: if the ELF loader is closed, the program opens it first through the Payload Manager. If that fails, the favorites are not sent and the log says so. That is why the ELF loader carries no star – neither do ShadowMount+ and DPI v2, which the program does not start itself.
- The checkbox **Send automatically at program start** (on by default) only switches off the sending at start; the **Send favorites** button stays yours.

### Q The FTP server is shown as “hangs”. What does that mean?

An aborted download can put `ftpsrv` into a state in which it keeps accepting connections and then stays silent. A freshly loaded payload does not help then – only a **restart of the console**. That is why the program checks not only the port but also whether the service answers.

### Q Why does “Cancel” stop a download from the PS5 only after the current file?

On purpose: a download aborted in the middle of a transfer cripples `ftpsrv` (see above). The program remembers your request and ends the transfer as soon as the current file has arrived completely.

### Q What can the library do?

- **This PC:** searches your scan folders for dump folders, images and packages and shows them as cards or a list – with cover image, platform, format and integrations.
- **PS5:** shows the backups at the usual storage locations and the installed PS5 and PS4 games.
- **Info & metadata** names version, SDK and required firmware – and “BACKPORT required” when the game needs more than your PS5 has.
- **Start** starts a title on the console via websrv (port 8080); if a game is running there, it is closed – the program asks first.
- **Copy** sends to the PS5 or downloads from it, **Convert** takes an entry over as the source.

A longer search shows a window with a progress bar and percentage and can be cancelled.

### Q How do I back up save data?

Backing up, decrypting and transferring between users is done by the **Garlic Save Manager** with its own interface (port 8082). There is no page of its own for it: on *Console & payloads* you select it in the table, start it with **Start selected** and open its interface with **Open web interface**. Make a backup before every write-back. A newly created console user finds its save data empty – the old saves stay with the original user.

### Q What does the WebKit Autoloader do, and which version should I use?

It creates the tile **WebKit Autoload** on the console (home screen, under *Media*) so that the entry can be repeated with one press. It consists of a **host** on your computer – as a Windows program or as a Python script – and an **installer** that runs once on the console. Both are under **CONSOLE › WebKit Autoloader**.

- **Version:** Several are bundled, from v0.4.0 to v0.6.1. The latest is preselected; the program remembers your choice, and it applies to all three paths (host as Windows program, host as Python script, send installer). If the latest does not work for you, try an older one.
- **Host:** It occupies DNS (UDP 53) and HTTPS (TCP 443) and therefore needs administrator rights.
- **Installer:** It goes to the console via port 9021. If the port is closed, it goes via FTP to the root of a USB drive; you pick it up there with the Payload Manager.

If a new version appears, the **Updates** button (see below) downloads its three files, or you put them into the folder `PS5 WebKit Autoloader` yourself in addition; the older ones stay selectable.

### How do I get newer versions of the bundled tools?

With the **Updates** button at the top right of the *Console & Payloads* page, next to *Check console*. It opens a window and immediately asks each tool's author for the latest release – the payloads in the folder `helloworld`, the WebKit Autoloader, AMPR EMU and the engines (MkPFS, UFS2Tool, LibProsperoPkg, OrbisPkgTool, PS5-PKG-Tool, PS5 Wee Tools, 7-Zip). This is the only network access; without the button the program never asks anywhere.

- **New version** can be ticked in the first column (click or space bar); **Download** fetches the selection. Every file is checked against the size and SHA-256 of the release before it is put in place; a tool that consists of several files arrives completely or not at all.
- Files go to `Werkzeug-Updates` in the program's settings folder – **never** into the bundled folders. The program takes the highest version there; bundled files stay untouched, and you may delete downloaded ones at any time.
- **New – install by hand** is shown for engines with own adjustments, for archives and for tools without a version in the file name: the window then only gives the verdict and opens the release page on request.
- GitHub allows 60 requests per hour without signing in; a full check needs about fifty. The program remembers the answers, so a second check hardly counts. When the limit is reached, the window names the time from which it works again.

> For elfldr, ftpsrv and klogsrv the program keeps using the tested bundled file in the table, when starting (favorites included) and in its own procedures; the downloaded one is available for sending in the quick selection.

### The ShadowMount+ button does not open a web interface. Why?

Up to 1.7beta7, ShadowMount+ listened by default only on the PS5 itself (`api_bind_address=127.0.0.1`); since 1.7beta8 it is `0.0.0.0`. If it listens only on the PS5, port 10101 is closed from your PC even though ShadowMount+ is running – and the button still sends the payload once more. If the port does not answer afterwards, the log states the reason. So set the key `api_bind_address` in the ShadowMount+ editor (*MORE TOOLS*) to the PS5 address or `0.0.0.0`. The interface has no login – do not use this on a network you do not control.

### What changes in config.ini from ShadowMount+ 1.7beta12?

ShadowMount+ 1.7beta12 stores `config.ini` in sections ( `[api]` , `[fakelib]` , `[emulators]` ...) and keeps settings per game and per image in a separate `profiles.ini` . Many keys have new names: `api_bind_address` is now `[api] bind_address` , `update_emulators` is now `[emulators] update_enabled` . The program therefore asks once whether your console runs the version before or from 1.7beta12 on and remembers the answer; you can change it under **SETTINGS** in the section *ShadowMount+ – config.ini*. If the console clearly holds the other format, the file on the console wins and the program tells you. The ShadowMount+ editor, **button 7**, the AMPR recording wizard and the NG hint read and write both formats; comments and your own sections stay. Do not copy an old `config.ini` over the new files – ShadowMount+ converts it itself at the first start and keeps a copy in `config-v1-backup/` .

### How do I use other controllers on the PS5 (AnyPad PS5)?

Since v1.9.60 the payload **AnyPad PS5** is bundled (now version 0.9.1-beta). It makes Bluetooth controllers usable on the PS5; games see them as a DualSense. According to its author, the DualShock 4 v2, 8BitDo SF30 Pro (Switch mode) and GameSir G7 SE are verified; Xbox and Switch Pro controllers among others are supported but not yet verified. On *Console & payloads* you start it with **Start selected** and open its pairing page (port 8095) with **Open web interface**.

- When the console asks who uses the controller, the author advises choosing **Quick play / Guest** (a temporary user).
- A DualShock 4 has to be paired again each time you switch it on; other controllers reconnect by themselves.
- Always stop AnyPad with the button on its web interface, also before starting it again.
- The page asks for no PIN: anyone on the same network can use it.

> Since October 2026 the project lives on Codeberg; port, page and usage notes come from the author's information.

### Q What do I need to do when updating CheatRunner?

The author requires three things **before** you send a new version (bundled: 0.18, port 9999):

- On the console, delete everything in `/data/cheatrunner` except the folders `cheats` and `patches` – before the first start of the new version, not after.
- Delete the old CheatRunner PKG (the tile on the home screen) from the PS5.
- Clear the browser cache: *Settings* → *System* → *Browser* → *Clear Cache*.

Then send the new `CheatRunner_v0.18.1.elf` as usual. The program deletes nothing on the console by itself.

> The steps come from the author's README (section "Updating CheatRunner").

### Q Does the program change anything on my console?

Only what you trigger: it sends payloads (they run until the console's next restart) and transfers files via FTP to the places you choose. In the library it renames nothing on the PS5, it only reads the list of installed games, and it writes **nothing into the console's system databases**.

## 6 Problems and help

### Q START stays greyed out.

Check whether source and target folder are chosen; the temp folder may stay empty – the program then works, on Windows, in a folder called “Temp - Dump-Image Converter” in the root of the system drive (usually C:). Task 8 needs no target folder. If the source is rejected, the chosen task does not fit the file type – then use task 6 or check the source with task 8.

### Q Message “sce_sys/param.json missing” or “param.json has no Content ID”.

**param.json missing:** the game is incomplete. With *Yes* the program creates a valid `param.json` and carries on building; with *No* it stops – in that case it is better to create a new backup from the original.

**Content ID missing:** title and content ID are not in any file of a backup, only the title ID. With *Look up missing metadata online* (settings) the program fetches both. Otherwise it enters a placeholder (`UP0000-<Title-ID>_00-…`); the old file is kept as `param.json.alt`. For updates and DLC the real content ID has to be entered.

### Q Message “eboot.bin not found in the source folder”.

An image has to carry the game directly in its root: `eboot.bin` and `sce_sys/param.json` sit in the folder itself, not in a subfolder – that is what ShadowMount+ requires. The program checks this before building (for `.ffpfsc`, `.ffpfs`, `.exFAT` and `.ffpkg`) and stops otherwise, instead of the problem only showing up on the console. Usually the chosen folder is one level too high – pick the folder in which `eboot.bin` sits directly.

### Q How do I get help with an error quickly?

Press **DIAGNOSTICS**. The report contains version, system, the last log lines and an assessment of the display and, since v1.9.90, an operation check with an overall verdict (errors in the log, missing programs, leftover work folders and mounted drives); credentials are blacked out automatically. It is saved as `Diagnosebericht_<date>.txt` in the settings folder. Also mention the chosen task, the source type and the last visible message – private paths or personal data only if they are needed for troubleshooting.

### Q What is the “doctor”?

The environment check answers the most common causes within seconds: long paths in Windows, the file system of the folders (FAT32 ends at 4 GB per file), free space and write permission, whether the bundled programs start, whether the settings file is intact. Run it in the program folder – on Windows in a command prompt opened **as administrator** (`X.Y.Z` stands for your version):

```
PS5_Dump_Image_Converter_vX.Y.Z.exe --doktor "E:\PS5_Temp" "E:\Target"
```

Both folder arguments are optional. `[ ok ]` means fine, `[ !! ]` a note, `[FEHL]` a real error, `[ -- ]` not needed. The check makes no connection to the internet; the same information appears in the DIAGNOSTICS window.

### Q The interface is too small or too large.

Under **SETTINGS** → *Display: scaling and resolution* you set the scaling (slider, 100 to at most 300 %, limited by the screen width) and the screen resolution by hand. Apply with **Apply and restart**; **Reset to automatic** restores the default.

### Q How do I change theme, background image and language?

- **THEME:** seven color schemes (Futuristic, Dark, Light, Metallic, Calm Graphite, Midnight Blue, Light and Clear); after APPLY the program restarts.
- **SETTINGS:** 20 bundled images each for the main area and the sidebar, or an image of your own, plus sliders for see-through, brightness and contrast. Light images are meant for the Light theme.
- **DE / EN / ES / IT / FR:** the language button shows the active language; each click switches the whole interface including the log to the next one (German, English, Spanish, Italian, French). This FAQ exists in all five languages; the **FAQ** button opens it in the language of the interface.

### Q Does the program send data to the internet?

On its own only a lookup of missing metadata: if title, publisher or category are missing, the game's **title ID** goes to store.playstation.com as well as prosperopatches.com (PS5) or orbispatches.com (PS4). Fetched details are kept for 30 days. By default this is on under Windows and Linux and off on the Mac; you can change it in the settings under *Metadata from the internet*. At startup the program also searches for the PS5 in your own network – that does not leave your home network. Downloads and updates only run when you press the button.

### Q Where can I find more help?

- This **FAQ** opens with the **FAQ** button at the top, left of **USER MANUAL** – in the language of the interface.
- The **user manual** opens with the button of that name – it is bundled with the program, no internet connection is needed. The manual exists in all five languages and opens in the language of the interface. Manual and FAQ are also included as PDF next to the program file.
- The guides on asset packs and on ShadowMount+ (old and new method) open with the **Guide** and **LZ4 & Asset Pack Guide** buttons.
- What changed in each version is listed in `CHANGELOG.md`.